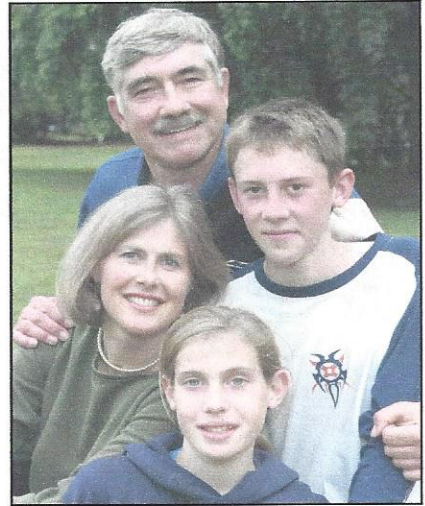




Saracoff Sentinel / Team Tijuana March 2004

Trip to the Miami headquarters of LAM

Our January trip to Miami to renew our relationship with the Latin America Mission was a joy. We were met with warmth by old and new friends there. We rejoiced at the discovery of their many resources that can help the ministries in Tijuana: web pages, books, a possible video, and most of all the warm support of all the staff. It was fun renewing these relationships and also during orientation finding our picture in their old publications and even in some of their current videos. A heavy schedule from 8:30 to 4 pm every weekday, several evening events, and outings on the weekends kept us busy. At the end of 10 days we got a couple days off and the head of the mission let us use his condo in the Keys. While Ian and Kathy relaxed & played, Anna and I went sea-fishing with President David Befus and Dave Summerill. Anna caught the most fish!



Elderly Home Experiences Growth

In the last six months the population at the home for the elderly has grown from 28 to over 50. This has put a strain on the budget to pay for food, electricity and water. To make matters worse, the center has had the expenses involved in burying three elderly this last month. Pray that their needs will be met. We were able to encourage Pastor Chuy and his leadership by holding a conference for his workers. Dr. Margaret Cottle,

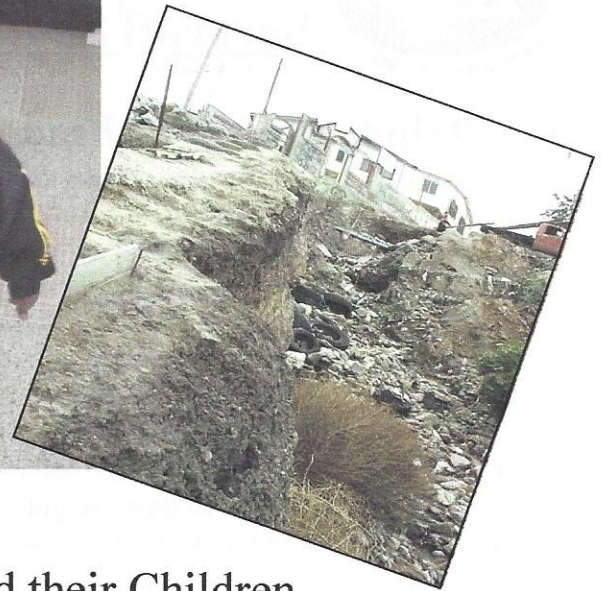
recently featured on "Focus on the Family," was the speaker. Her co-authored book on how to care for the elderly has brought concern for the elderly to the attention of many. Margaret Cottle with her husband Rob and daughter Myra came from Canada and spent their time encouraging Pastor Chuy and others in Tijuana. They encouraged us by helping prepare the envelopes for this newsletter.

Special Needs of the Home for Elderly:

- Prayer for the Mexican volunteers—may the joy of the Lord be their strength, and may they see His provision to meet needs.
- Three of the elderly died this month. Funerals at \$300 represent a large budget item. We could reduce these costs by building some simple coffins. This would be a great little project for a group of teens.
- Chuy is working on expanding his dining hall and adding a room for a medical clinic. Teams are always welcome.
- On-going financial needs exist to pay for water and electric bills.



Kathy's Corner *"The weapons we fight with are not the weapons of the world. On the contrary, they have divine power to demolish strongholds. We demolish arguments and every pretension that sets itself up against the knowledge of God, and we take captive every thought to make it obedient to Christ."* My battlefield lately has been the mind and I'm so glad God gave us the powerful weapons of **His Word** and **prayer** to do battle with the worries, fears, anger and resentment that come pounding. (2 Cor. 10:4-5)



La Roca

Shelter for Single Mothers and their Children Tries to Fight Erosion!

In Tijuana when it rains, it pours! The unpaved roads that are in poor areas become next to impassable in hilly Grupo Mexico. The special type of clay there is like driving on ice. Water erodes large ditches through the roads. The persevering servants of God at **La Roca** press on. Patching up the dirt road has become a recurring project for them and the city of Tijuana. Even if **La Roca** can raise enough funds to pave the street, however, the neighbors must also pay their share, so the paving seems at times to be an impossible task. Pastor Miguel still says it will be done in God's way.

Perhaps worse than the physical erosion of the landscape is the spiritual erosion of the family and the virtue of the people of Tijuana. Fathers abandon their families for drugs, crime, or just an irresponsible life style. Mothers with little education, trying at times to overcome abuse, have to somehow hold their families together. We believe that **La Roca**, a shelter that takes in single mothers and their children and gives them support and a Christian witness, is the answer to this problem. You could help by contributing to the paving or to on-going expenses of **La Roca** (three people giving \$50/month would cover their monthly water bill of \$150). And pray!

Remember to send all donations through LAM now for the Saracoffs and the ministries with which they work. CFCI will no longer forward these funds.

Please send all funds to:

Latin America Mission
P.O. Box 527900
Miami, FL 33152-7900
(use enclosed card)



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